

knows that those criteria are false. With reference to the NT, the ‘harder’ reading criterion is obviously perverse.

Question 5) is totally subjective, subject to the critic’s whim, bias, theoretical orientation, personal perversity, or whatever. This criterion is unacceptable on its face. Why should any servant of Satan be allowed to determine the wording of the Text, based on his personal preference?

Anyone who respects objective evidence should reject the five criteria discussed above. Anyone who respects objective evidence should understand that the transmission of the NT Text was basically normal, and that the mass of extant MSS must be accorded the respect that they deserve. All the extant MSS deserve to be collated, thereby allowing us to group them empirically. The empirically defined families must then be compared and evaluated. The canard, ‘MSS should be weighed, not counted’, is a cop-out.

f³⁵ Subgroups in the General Epistles¹

There are fourteen significant splits in the Family in the four larger books (there being none in the three shorter ones), as follows:

James 2:13	ελεον 432 ^{alt} , 1766 ^c ελεος 328, 394 {432, 604} ² 634, 664, 928, 986, 1247, 1249, 1482, 1548, 1619 ^c , 1636, 1725, 1732 ^{alt} , 1749, 1752, 1766, 1897, 2080, 2221, 2289, 2587, 2704
James 2:14	εχει εχη 141, 328, 386, 394, 604, 634, 664, 801, 928, 986, 1075, 1247, 1249, 1250, 1482, 1508, 1548, 1656, 1704, 1737, 1746, 1748, 1749, 1752, 1766, 1855, 1876, 1899, 2218, 2221, 2289, 2431, 2501, 2587, 2626, 2704
1 Peter 1:23	αλλ αλλα {149, 201} {432, 604} 757, 824, 1072, 1075, 1248, 1250, 1503, 1548, 1617, 1618, 1619, 1628, 1636, 1637, 1656, 1740, 1745, 1746, 1748, 1754, 1763, 1768, 1864, 1892, 2352, 2431, 2777
1 Peter 2:11	απεχεσθαι 1072 ^{alt} απεχεσθε {149, 201} 204, 604 ^c , 757 ^{alt} , 824, 1072, 1248, 1503 ^c , 1548, 1617, 1618, 1619 ^{alt} , 1628 ^{alt} , 1637 ^c , 1745 ^{alt} , 1746, 1748, 1864 ^{alt} , 1899, 2352, 2431, 2704, 2777
1 Peter 2:24	απογενομενοι απογεννωμενοι (328) ³ 394 {432 (604)} 664, 928, 986, 1247, 1249, 1482, 1508, 1548, 1752, 1763, 1766, 1768, 1855, 2289, 2587 (2704)

¹ This study uses 77 out of 84 known family members; the seven that are missing would probably make little, if any, difference to our conclusions. Out of the 77 MSS, all of those not listed with the alternate go with the main form. Thus in James 2:14, the 36 MSS that have the alternate should be subtracted from 77, which leaves 41 for the main form.

² MSS within braces, { }, have a common exemplar and may be treated as a single vote.

³ A MS within () has a slight variation on the given form.